

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

	Questions	Answers
1.	How long have you been in property management?	
2.	What is your specialty type of property (asset type A B C)?	
3.	What is the mix of type of properties in your portfolio: Single-family, small multi-family, larger multi-family, retail, industrial, commercial?	
4.	How many total units do you presently manage?	
5.	Do you manage any units near my property? If so, exactly where are they so I can drive by?	
6.	Have you or your staff been accredited or certified by the Institute of Real Estate Management or the National Association of Residential Property Managers?	
7.	What local or regional property management related organizations do you belong to?	
8.	Do you have a company code of ethics?	
9.	If not, will you agree in writing to abide by IREM and NARPM Codes of Ethics? www.irem.org/i02_about/html/CPM_Code.html or www.narpm.org/?page=narpm_ethics	
10.	Has your firm been sued or been in arbitration with one of your owner/clients in the last five years? If so, please describe the situation and how it was resolved.	
11.	How many people in your company hold state Property Manager's licenses? What are their names?	

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

12.	Would one of them be specifically assigned to my property? Which one?	
13.	Do you have a company policy and procedures manual I can read?	
14.	If you managed my property, what additional staff would you hire, if any? If none, how would you organize your work to accommodate my property?	
15.	On what schedule will you or your off-site management staff visit and inspect the property?	
16.	Would you use an on-site manager for this property? If so, will you pay their salary, taxes, and insurance, or will I? How much?	
17.	What will be the on-site manager's (if any) duties? Will he or she do turnover cleaning and repair?	
18.	Are there any up-front fees I am expected to pay at the beginning of our agreement?	
19.	Would you provide a written management plan at the start?	
20.	What fee do you charge for finding and installing a new tenant? If a tenant moves out within a few months, will you waive it for the next tenant? If you ever have to evict a tenant; will you waive the lease-up fee? What if I find the tenant?	
21.	What percentage of gross income do you charge for monthly management?	
22.	What is included with the monthly management fee?	

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

23.	Is advertising included in the management fee?	
24.	For moneys held in your client trust account, is interest paid? To whom does the interest accrue (me, you, us)?	
25.	Would you consider a net/net lease, whereby you lease the property, subleasing to the tenants, pay the operating expenses, and just pay me a flat fee? If so, what rate would you propose?	
26.	Which property management software do you use?	
27.	Does your software allow you to project an annual operating budget for your properties, and then compare the actual performance to the budget?	
28.	Please submit samples of the types of monthly and quarterly reports it generates that you would normally send us.	
29.	Will you produce my IRS Schedule E or Form 8825 at the end of the year?	
30.	What do you typically do to prepare a unit for re-renting (turnover)?	
31.	How much time do you take to prepare a unit for re-rent? Would you commit to that in writing?	
32.	Do you have your own repair staff? If so, what are their qualifications, and what types of work are they NOT qualified to do (for which you have to hire outside contractors)?	
33.	If you use outside contractors for maintenance and repair, which ones?	

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

34.	What is the hourly rate charged for work performed by your repair staff? Contractors?	
35.	Can we pay a flat fee for turnover expenses, such as cleaning, carpet cleaning, and painting, instead of an hourly rate?	
36.	When outside maintenance and cleaning contractors are used, will you charge us an "override" on their bills? If so, how much will this be?	
37.	Over what amount do you typically seek permission of the owner before having repairs or done?	
38.	Who will handle the landscaping and lawn maintenance for this property?	
39.	If I wanted you to raise it to the market rent, how soon and on what schedule should we raise them?	
40.	What security deposit do you propose charging? Will this be collected all up-front, or will you allow the tenants to pay it over time?	
41.	If I have a vacancy, how long do you think it will take to re-rent it at the current rent? Market rent?	
42.	Would you want to offer concessions to fill a vacancy in the current market? What type, and how much will they cost?	
43.	What is the longest period of vacancy you've experienced in the last year?	
44.	What hours will your staff be available to show vacancies to prospective tenants?	
45.	What is your typical advertising budget for filling a vacancy in the current market?	

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

46.	Where would you advertise vacancies for my property?	
47.	Do you have an Internet site, or advertise vacancies on an Internet site? If so, do you provide pictures and other information? Please provide the Web address.	
48.	Please submit a sample classified advertisement you would use to promote my property.	
49.	If a tenant must be evicted, will you handle it yourselves, or will you contract it out? To whom?	
50.	If a tenant must be evicted, what charge will I pay?	
51.	How many evictions have you performed in the last year?	
52.	What do you do to recover costs and fees and unpaid rent from evicted tenants? Collection agency? Small claims court? Who pays the fees for these?	
53.	Do you recommend month-to-month tenancies for this property or leases?	
54.	What late fee will be charged to the tenants? Is that credited to me or you?	
55.	What is your procedure if a tenant's rent check is returned as unpaid?	
56.	Describe your tenant screening and qualification procedures.	
57.	What is the tenant screening charge to me?	

67 Questions to Screen Property Managers

58.	For my review, please submit a copy of your tenant screening standards, application, rental agreement, and move-in/move-out checklist.	
59.	Please submit a copy of your standard Property Management Agreement.	
60.	If I find something in the Property Management Agreement objectionable or wish to add to it, can we modify it to suit my needs?	
61.	How much notice to you require for terminating the Property Management Agreement?	
62.	Do you require us to list the property with your company when it comes time to sell?	
63.	What are your normal business hours?	
64.	Who should tenants contact after normal business hours?	
65.	If I have a problem with an employee, what procedure should I follow?	
66.	Will you give me either your cell phone number or home number?	
67.	What are some of the reasons we should use your company?	